

Oral Surgery: Alveoloplasty and Vestibuloplasty

Policy Number: DCP028.13

Effective Date: September 1, 2026

[Instructions for Use](#)

Table of Contents	Page
Coverage Rationale	1
Definitions	2
Applicable Codes	2
Description of Services	2
References	2
Policy History/Revision Information	3
Instructions for Use	3

Related Dental Policies

- [Oral Surgery: Miscellaneous Surgical Procedures](#)
- [Oral Surgery: Non-Pathologic Excisional Procedures](#)

Related Medical Policy

- [Cosmetic and Reconstructive Procedures](#)

Coverage Rationale

Alveoloplasty

Alveoloplasty is indicated for the following:

- For bone recontouring and smoothing as part of the tooth extraction process
- For bone recontouring and smoothing as a standalone procedure prior to fixed or removable prosthetic construction
- To provide stability for implant placement
- For debulking procedures for pathologic conditions of the bone

Alveoloplasty may not be indicated for the following:

- When removing bone would harm vital structures
- When there is diminished volume or atypical architecture of bone
- For individuals who have undergone radiation therapy to the head and neck
- Individuals with an unmanaged medical condition; these conditions include but are not limited to metabolic, cardiovascular, and autoimmune/inflammatory, as well as genetic conditions that affect collagen synthesis
- Individuals taking medications that negatively affects the healing response; these include but are not limited to immunosuppressive agents, corticosteroids, anticoagulants, NSAIDs, and nicotine
- For individuals who have undergone radiation therapy to the head and neck

Vestibuloplasty

Vestibuloplasty is indicated for the following:

- Ridge extension, or lowering or altering submucous displacing attachments prior to prosthetic construction
- To complement and complete osseous procedure when reconstructing edentulous bone
- To correct inadequate or inappropriate soft tissue drape where a resection has been previously performed and prosthetic restoration requires improvement
- For overall stability of a dental implant and the maintenance of bone health around an implant

Vestibuloplasty may not be indicated for the following:

- Individuals with an unmanaged medical condition; these conditions include but are not limited to metabolic, cardiovascular, and autoimmune/inflammatory, as well as genetic conditions that affect collagen synthesis
- Individuals taking medications that negatively affects the healing response; these include but are not limited to immunosuppressive agents, corticosteroids, anticoagulants, NSAIDs, and nicotine
- When there is minimal alveolar ridge height
- For individuals who have undergone radiation therapy to the head and neck

Definitions

Alveoloplasty: Surgical procedure for recontouring supporting bone, sometimes in preparation for a prosthesis. (ADA)

Vestibuloplasty: Any of a series of surgical procedures designed to increase relative alveolar ridge height. (ADA)

Applicable Codes

The following list(s) of procedure and/or diagnosis codes is provided for reference purposes only and may not be all inclusive. Listing of a code in this guideline does not imply that the service described by the code is a covered or non-covered health service. Benefit coverage for health services is determined by the member specific benefit plan document and applicable laws that may require coverage for a specific service. The inclusion of a code does not imply any right to reimbursement or guarantee claim payment. Other policies and guidelines may apply.

CDT Code	Description
D7310	Alveoloplasty in conjunction with extractions – four or more teeth or tooth spaces, per quadrant
D7311	Alveoloplasty in conjunction with extractions – one to three teeth or tooth spaces, per quadrant
D7320	Alveoloplasty not in conjunction with extractions -four or more teeth or tooth spaces, per quadrant
D7321	Alveoloplasty not in conjunction with extractions – one to three teeth or tooth spaces, per quadrant
D7340	Vestibuloplasty – ridge extension (secondary epithelialization)
D7350	Vestibuloplasty – ridge extension (including soft tissue grafts, muscle reattachment, revision of soft tissue attachment and management of hypertrophied and hyperplastic tissue)

CDT® is a registered trademark of the American Dental Association

Description of Services

Alveoloplasty is a surgical procedure to recontour and/or smooth out the alveolar bone. This is usually done in areas where teeth have been extracted and there is uneven or sharp edges, to facilitate an optimal foundation for tooth replacement procedures such as removable and fixed prostheses, and implants.

Vestibuloplasty is a surgical procedure designed to restore alveolar ridge height by lowering muscles attaching to the alveolar bone. It is most often seen when preparing the mouth for dentures or an implant.

Pursuant to CA AB2585: While not common in dentistry, nonpharmacological pain management strategies should be encouraged if appropriate.

References

American Dental Association (ADA) CDT Codebook 2026.

American Dental Association (ADA). Glossary of Dental Clinical and Administrative Terms.

Drew, Stephanie Joy. Atlas of Oral and Maxillofacial Surgery, 2nd ed. St. Louis: Elsevier, Inc. c2023. Chapter 14, Alveoloplasty; p. 113-119.

Kerr A, Miller C, Nelson R. Little and Falace's Dental Management of the Medically Compromised Patient, 10th ed. St. Louis: Elsevier c2024. Chapter 1, Patient Evaluation, Risk Assessment, and the Diagnostic Process; p. 1-17.

Murdoch-Kinch CA, Zwetchkenbaum S. Dental management of the head & neck cancer patient treated with radiation therapy. Today's FDA. 2011 Sep-Oct;23(6):40-3.

National Institute of Dental and Craniofacial Research. Oral Complications of Cancer Treatment: What the Dental Team Can Do.

Perciaccante, Vincent J. and Krishnan, Deepak. Atlas of Oral and Maxillofacial Surgery, 2nd ed. St. Louis: Elsevier, Inc. c2023. Chapter 19, Vestibuloplasty; p. 153-169.

Policy History/Revision Information

Date	Summary of Changes
09/01/2026	Supporting Information - Updated <i>References</i> section to reflect the most current information - Archived previous policy version DCP028.12

Instructions for Use

This Dental Clinical Policy provides assistance in interpreting UnitedHealthcare standard and Medicare Advantage dental plans. When deciding coverage, the member specific benefit plan document must be referenced as the terms of the member specific benefit plan may differ from the standard dental plan. In the event of a conflict, the member specific benefit plan document governs. Before using this policy, check the member specific benefit plan document and any applicable federal or state mandates. UnitedHealthcare reserves the right to modify its policies and guidelines as necessary. This Dental Clinical Policy is provided for informational purposes. It does not constitute medical advice.